CALVARY EXOTICS

Where Isopods Come From

NATIVE LOCALES OF OUR ISOPODS

Isopods are found on every continent, but each species started somewhere. Knowing where an isopod comes from tells you what climate it likes. Locales below are the native range of each species.

1 Europe & the Mediterranean

The Porcellio and Powder isopods. Temperate to warm, rocky, leaf-littered ground.



Giant Canyon

Porcellio dilatatus

Southern Europe and the Mediterranean. A big, bold woodlouse from dry, rocky country.



Dairy Cow

Porcellio laevis

Same species as our Whites: Mediterranean origin, spread worldwide by people. Spotted morph.



Orange Koi

Porcellio scaber

Western Europe, like all P. scaber. Found under bark, logs and stones in damp woods and gardens.



Red Koi

Porcellionides pruinosus

Same species as our Powders: Mediterranean origin, found in warm regions around the globe.



White

Porcellio laevis

Mediterranean region, now found worldwide. Warmth-loving; lives in leaf litter, under stones and in compost.



Lemonade

Porcellio scaber

Western Europe. The common rough woodlouse, now on nearly every continent.



Powder Mix

Porcellionides pruinosus

Mediterranean and southern Europe, now worldwide. Loves warm, damp compost and leaf litter.

CARE TAKEAWAY These species come from milder climates, so they tolerate cooler, drier conditions better than tropical isopods. Give them a damp side and a dry side.

2 Southeast Asia

The Cubaris, often called “rubber ducky” types. Warm, humid forest floors and limestone country.



Glacier

Cubaris sp.



Crystal Pineapple

Cubaris sp.



Panda King

Cubaris sp.



White Shark

Cubaris sp.

CARE TAKEAWAY Cubaris is a Southeast Asian genus. These trade morphs have not been formally described to species, so the exact collection locality is not documented. Treat them as warm-climate, humid-leaf-litter animals.

3 The Warm Tropics

A tiny cleanup-crew species found in warm places around the world.



Dwarf White

Trichorhina tomentosa

Tropical and subtropical regions worldwide. Native range is uncertain, often traced to the Americas. Tiny, pale, and fond of warm, moist soil.

CARE TAKEAWAY Keep it warm and moist. It does not handle cold.

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